

Paulos Yibelo - Hacking Research: Why CSP Should be carefully crafted: Twitter XSS & CSP Bypass

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- xxxxx, Paulos Yibelo - Hacking Research.

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Content

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Few months back, I came across an oauth xss accompanied by a nice CSP bypass in Twitter. While creating an application, a developer can set their terms and service URL for their app, which Twitter configured to be: `* ([https?:])\w+ *`

* *

Unfortunately the regexp is missing a `^` char in the start making malicious URLs like `data:CONTENT#https://...` work -- so we got HTML Injection, but almost useless for a practical attack because of the CSP rules. After checking the header, I noticed there are multiple CSP misconfigurations in the script-src and object-src blocks, making it possible to bypass CSP in twitter.com. The CSP Rule looks like:

* *

```
script-src https://connect.facebook.net https://cm.g.doubleclick.net https://ssl.google-analytics.com
https://graph.facebook.com https://twitter.com 'unsafe-eval' 'unsafe-inline' https://*.twimg.com
https://api.twitter.com https://analytics.twitter.com https://publish.twitter.com https://ton.twitter.com
https://syndication.twitter.com https://www.google.com;frame-ancestors 'self';object-src
https://twitter.com https://pbs.twimg.com; default-src 'self';...
```

* *

Looking at this, the object-src and the script-src blocks got my immediate attention.

After some research, I saw one of the trusted domains (`cdn.syndication.twimg.com` aka `syndication.twitter.com`) hosts JSONP endpoints.

Originally I thought, by exploiting the object-src block (<https://pbs.twimg.com>) -- one can upload a Flash file (as picture/video extension with few bytes header) to Twitter CDN -- refer it to as an embedded Object to gain code execution. However, because of character limitation, the payload I was trying to make was too long and being cut off, so this method wasn't practical as we were working on a limited payload space. At this point, I stucked to the JSONP bypass for the script-src blocks and started playing with multiple parameters until I found a shorter version, when injected generating an alert in twitter.com.

* *

```
http://syndication.twitter.com/widgets/timelines/246079887021051904?
dnt=true&domain=twitter.com&lang=en&callback=alert
```

* *

The above JSONP response from syndication.twitter.com comes back with a Content-Disposition header forcing a download. However, browsers like Chrome still execute the returned file even when returned as an attachment. At this point, this misconfiguration added with the 'unsafe-inline' CSP block -- meant we are able to execute code.

* *

By setting the Terms & Services URL of an App to

* *

```
data:text/html,<script src="https://syndication.twitter.com/widgets/timelines/246079887021051904?callback=alert"></script>
```

* *

A developer will be able to pop-up an alert.

POC

* *

After some digging I noticed ssl.google-analytics.com, www.google.com and even graph.facebook.com host JSONP endpoints -- which I wrote to twitter over email -- but will not be fixed anytime soon because it may break the sites usage and call to these sites and performance.

Edit: Ben Hayak [mentioned](#) we can use same origin method execution (SOME) attack to manipulate the page as we like: <https://syndication.twitter.com/widgets/timelines/246079887021051904?callback=document.body.firstChild.Reference.submit> -- as used by my [Instagram XSS](#).

* *

I hope it was a fun read, :) --

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